Wild and Rare: Nature Next Door

Day 1 · Reading (1 of 2)

What to do: Read it aloud, one paragraph each. Stop at every blue word: can anybody explain it?

Vocabulary topic: Wild nature near us
20 new words (in blue) · EEW 1, Unit 5 · read about wild animals and talk about nature around you



easy parts harder parts (most new words are here)

Do you live in a city? Then wild animals live near you, too. You are not always **aware** of them, but they are there. In London there are about 10,000 foxes. In Mumbai, leopards live at the edge of the city. In many cities, birds, hedgehogs and small foxes walk through the parks at night. The city is their home, too.

Why do wild animals **reside** in cities? The **result** of building more houses is that the **wild** places get smaller, so animals look for food and a safe place. A fox is clever: it learns that a garden is a good **field** for catching mice, and a quiet street is a good road. This is **normal** behavior, and the fox does not want to **hurt** anybody. But a very hungry animal can behave **badly**, so it is better to keep your distance.

If you see a fox, stay calm. Do not feed it, do not touch it and do not run. Look at it for a few seconds, then **continue** your walk. In most cases, the fox walks away first.

Some animals are very **rare**, and seeing one is a special **experience**. The snow leopard, for example, lives high in the mountains of Central Asia, and it is almost never **visible**. Scientists put cameras in the mountains and wait for months. A researcher can work for a whole year and see the animal only once. When that happens, people say the scientist had good **judgment**: he or she chose the right place for the camera.

Nature is not only about animals. Think about the sky. On some winter nights, people in the north see green and pink lights above them: the northern lights. They are rare in southern countries, but after a strong storm on the Sun the lights can be visible much farther south than usual.

Wild and Rare: Nature Next Door

Day 1 · Reading (2 of 2)

What to do: After reading: which paragraphs were easy, which were hard? Which blue words did you know already?

How can we **relax** in nature? Many doctors **request** that stressed patients spend two hours a week in a park or a forest. Studies show that after twenty minutes the heart slows down and the mind becomes quieter. You do not need to walk far: a small park is **likely** to help almost as much as a big one. We **belong** to nature, and the body knows it.

Everybody makes an **error** sometimes. Imagine you travel far to see a rare bird, and you take 200 photos. Later an expert says: it is a chicken. That is a funny mistake, but people who watch nature make mistakes like this all the time. And do you know the hedgehog's trick? When it is in danger, it can **roll** into a ball, and its sharp hair keeps it safe.

I live in a big city, and it is a long time **since** I saw a wild animal near my home. Last week I saw one: a small hedgehog under a bush in the park. I stopped and watched it for five minutes. It did not see me. It was a small moment, but I remember it very well.

Studies of city animals show a surprising thing: foxes in cities are bolder than foxes in the countryside. They learn that people usually do not hurt them, so they come closer. A bold fox can become a problem if people feed it, because then it starts to expect food from everybody.

Do you want to help wild animals near your home? It is easy. Put a bowl of water in the garden in hot weather. Leave a small pile of leaves in a corner: hedgehogs love it. And keep your cat inside at night.

Next time you walk in a park, stop for one minute. Listen. How many sounds can you hear? Look at the trees: is anything moving? Nature is always there. We only need one minute to see it.

The 20 words

Day 1 · Vocabulary table · Topic: Wild nature near us

What to do: Book: 4000 EEW 1, Unit 5, pages 32–35. Copy the words you do not know into the copybook.

Word	Meaning	По-русски	Example
aware adj.	knowing that something is there	осведомлённый; знать о	Are you aware of the danger?
badly adv.	in a bad way	плохо, сильно	He hurt his leg badly.
belong v.	be in the right place; be part of a group	принадлежать; быть на своём месте	This bag belongs to me.
continue v.	keep going, not stop	продолжать	Please continue reading.
error n.	a mistake	ошибка	There is an error in your answer.
experience n.	something you do or see; knowledge from doing	опыт; впечатление	The trip was a great experience.
field n.	a large open area of land	поле	Cows were eating grass in the field.
hurt v.	cause pain	ранить, причинять боль; болеть	I hurt my knee yesterday.
judgment n.	the ability to decide well	суждение, здравый смысл	Use good judgment: don't touch wild animals.
likely adj.	probably going to happen	вероятный	It is likely to rain today.
normal adj.	usual, not strange	нормальный, обычный	It was a normal day at school.
rare adj.	not often seen; not common	редкий	White tigers are very rare.
relax v.	rest and feel calm	отдыхать, расслабляться	I relax in the evening.
request n./v.	ask for something politely	просьба; просить	The teacher listened to our request.
reside v.	live in a place (formal)	проживать	The fox resided in the clinic for two weeks.
result n.	what happens because of something	результат	The test results were great.
roll v.	turn over and over like a ball	катить(ся)	The ball rolled down the hill.
since conj./prep.	from a time in the past until now	так как; с (тех пор)	Since it was late, we went home.
visible adj.	able to be seen	видимый	The stars were visible last night.
wild adj.	living in nature, not with people	дикий	Wild animals live in forests.

More on the topic

Day 1 · Topic: Wild nature near us · more words

What to do: Choose 5 collocations to learn. Use the reserve words when a student already knows the main ones.

Collocations: words that go together

be aware of…	осознавать, знать о…
wild animals	дикие животные
a rare bird · a rare chance	редкая птица · редкая возможность
a normal day	обычный день
a visible mark	заметный след
make an error	сделать ошибку
relax in the park	отдыхать в парке
likely to rain	вероятно, будет дождь
belong to…	принадлежать…
a good result	хороший результат
a nice experience	приятный опыт
roll down the hill	катиться с холма

Phrasal verbs

carry on	продолжать	Carry on walking: the fox will go away.
keep away from	держаться подальше от	Keep away from wild animals.
look out for	высматривать; остерегаться	Look out for snakes in the grass.
slow down	замедлиться	Slow down and enjoy the view.
set up	установить, настроить	The scientists set up a camera.
watch out	быть осторожным	Watch out! There is a hole.

Reserve words: for students who know the 20 already, or if you prefer another word

fox	лиса	**footprint**	след (ноги)
leopard	леопард	**hunt**	охотиться
hedgehog	ёж	**feed**	кормить
nest	гнездо	**habitat**	среда обитания
forest	лес	**endangered**	находящийся под угрозой

What to read next · 4000 Essential English Words

This week: **Book 1, Unit 5, “The Jackal and the Sun Child”**, pages 32–37. Next: **Unit 6, “The Friendly Ghost”**, pages 38–43. More wild animals: **Unit 4, “The Dog’s Bell”**, pages 26–31.